

CUB SCOUT PACK 376

BEAR Parent Guide

3rd Grade | 2026-2027 Scouting Year

Bears are third graders. They can handle longer walks, simple tools, and more responsibility within the den.

Welcome to the Bear year! Third graders step up to a one-mile walk, more hands-on citizenship, and optional tool and pocketknife skills. Most program work happens through den and pack activities, with a few items completed at home.

How Your Scout Earns the Bear Badge

To earn the Bear rank badge, your Scout completes all 6 required Adventures below, plus at least 2 elective Adventures of their choosing. Most requirements are completed through den meetings, pack activities, family activities, outings, and other scheduled Scouting opportunities. Your den leader tracks progress and gives final sign-off.

The 6 Required Adventures

Adventure	What your Scout will work on	Where
Bobcat <i>Character & Leadership</i>	Learn the Scout Oath and Law, help create a den Code of Conduct, learn the denner role and signs, and complete the child-protection booklet at home.	Den + Home
Bear Habitat <i>Outdoors</i>	Plan and take a one-mile walk using Leave No Trace - map the route, handle trash, look for wildlife signs, and practice courteous trail behavior.	Den / Family
Bear Strong <i>Personal Fitness</i>	Explore healthy foods, complete stretching/movement and exercise activities, relax, and review the health form with an adult.	Den + Home
Paws for Action <i>Citizenship</i>	Learn U.S. flag history and handling, national symbols, how a nonprofit serves the community, and take part in a service project.	Den + Pack
Standing Tall <i>Personal Safety</i>	Watch the Protect Yourself Rules video, complete the Personal Space Bubble activity, set a family device policy, and learn about safety gear.	Home + Den
Fellowship <i>Family & Reverence</i>	Explore your family's faith traditions, attend a service or gathering, do an act of kindness, and learn about another faith tradition.	Family

Family & Reverence note: this Adventure may also be completed through the religious-emblem option when provided by the current rank requirements.

Choosing Elective Adventures (pick at least 2)

Your Scout chooses at least 2 electives to complete the rank and may complete additional electives for more recognition.

Elective Adventures

A Bear Goes Fishing | Balancing Bears | Baloo the Builder | Bears Afloat | Bears on Bikes | Champions for Nature | Chef Tech | Critter Care | Forensics | Let's Camp | Marble Madness | Race Time | Roaring Laughter | Salmon Run | Summertime Fun | Super Science | Whittling

Range & Target Sports (Archery, BB Gun, Slingshot): optional electives offered only through approved council- or district-operated events with qualified range personnel - not as regular pack or den unit activities.

Year at a Glance - What to Plan For

Overnights	None required for the Bear rank. The optional 'Let's Camp' elective includes an approved overnight camping experience.
Service project	A service project is part of Paws for Action. No specific hour minimum is stated in the Adventure requirement.
Outdoor / hiking	Bear Habitat includes a planned one-mile walk using Leave No Trace.
Swimming & water	Optional only - Bears Afloat requires passing the Scouting America swimmer test before later paddle-craft requirements. Salmon Run is supervised swimming-skill work.
Range & target	Optional only - Archery, BB Gun, and Slingshot are limited to approved council/district events with qualified range personnel.
Parent involvement	Not required at every meeting. Whittling is optional and introduces pocketknife skills under appropriate adult supervision.

What We Need From You at Home

A few requirements are completed at home with your Scout. Other requirements may happen through den meetings, pack activities, family activities, outings, campouts, service projects, or other scheduled Scouting activities:

- Complete the 'How to Protect Your Children from Child Abuse: A Parent's Guide' booklet activities (part of Bobcat).
- Watch the Bear Protect Yourself Rules video and complete the Personal Space Bubble activity.
- Set a family policy for digital devices (part of Standing Tall).
- Review the Annual Health and Medical Record together (part of Bear Strong).
- Help with the Family & Reverence activities assigned to the family.

Tips for a Great Year

- Come to den and pack meetings - that is where many Adventures are earned.
- Watch the pack calendar so you can plan around outings, campouts, the Pinewood Derby, and service projects.
- Keep the handbook handy and celebrate each Adventure as it is completed.
- Ask your den leader anytime you are unsure what is coming up next.

Questions? Reach out to your den leader or pack leadership - we are glad to help.